



HUSTLE STUDIO TOOLKIT

Freelance Client & Invoice Tracker

Know who owes you, who to chase, and what your pipeline is really worth

Contents

01 Set it up in 10 minutes

02 The 5-minute Monday money check

Set it up in 10 minutes

This workbook replaces the sticky notes, the "did they pay yet?" inbox searches and the end-of-month panic. It has five tabs, and you only type in the highlighted cells.

Tab	What you type	What it calculates
Dashboard	Your monthly income goal	Collected this month, progress, outstanding, overdue, pipeline, real hourly rate
Clients	Name, contact, email, source	Total invoiced, total paid, outstanding per client
Projects	Stage, quoted fee, win chance, hours	Weighted pipeline, planned vs effective hourly rate
Invoices	Issue date, terms, amount, payment	Due date, balance, status, days overdue, which reminder to send

Step 1: set your goal

Open **Dashboard** and replace 6,000 with your own monthly income goal. Not sure what it should be? Use your floor rate × the billable hours you realistically sell per month.

Step 2: add clients

One row per client. Type the name **exactly** as you will type it on invoices ("Lumen Coffee", not "Lumen"). The totals pull automatically.

Step 3: log projects, including the ones you haven't won

Every lead and every proposal gets a row. Use these win chances unless you have your own history:

- Lead: 20%
- Proposal sent: 50%
- Won or Done: 100%

- Lost: 0%

The **weighted pipeline** on the Dashboard is quoted fee × win chance, summed. It's a far more honest number than "I have three proposals out".

Step 4: log invoices

Enter invoice number, client, issue date, payment terms in days (7, 14 or 30) and amount. When money arrives, add the paid date and amount paid. Partial payments are fine: the balance stays open.

Worked example (already in the file)

Invoice	Client	Terms	Amount	Paid	Status	Send this
INV-001	Northwind Studio	14 days	\$4,200	\$4,200	Paid	
INV-003	Atlas Legal	14 days	\$1,200	\$0	Overdue 26 days	Final notice + late fee
INV-004	Lumen Coffee	7 days	\$1,200	\$600	Overdue 14 days	Firm reminder
INV-005	Atlas Legal	14 days	\$1,200	\$0	Overdue 4 days	Friendly nudge

The example dates are relative to today, so the statuses always look like a real week. Overwrite them with your own invoices.

The 5-minute Monday money check

Most late payments are not bad clients. They are invoices nobody followed up on. The tracker tells you exactly who to chase and how firmly.

The routine

1. Open **Invoices** and sort by **Days overdue** (largest first).
2. Send the reminder shown in **Send this** for each overdue row.
3. Open **Projects**: follow up any proposal older than 5 days.
4. Glance at **Dashboard**: collected this month vs goal.

Which reminder, when

Days overdue	Send this	Tone
1–7	Friendly nudge	Assume it slipped through
8–21	Firm reminder	Restate amount, date and terms
22+	Final notice + late fee	Name the next step and the date

Copy-ready reminders

Friendly nudge

Hi [Name], a quick note that invoice [INV-005] for [\$1,200] was due on [date]. Could you let me know when it's scheduled? I've attached it again here. Thanks!

Firm reminder

Hi [Name], invoice [INV-004] has a remaining balance of [\$600], now [14] days past due. Per our terms, payment was due within [7] days. Please confirm a payment date by [Friday].

Final notice

Hi [Name], invoice [INV-003] for [\$1,200] is now [26] days overdue. If payment isn't received by [date], a late fee of [1.5% per month] will apply as set out in our agreement, and I'll need to pause further work. Happy to talk if something is holding it up.

Only mention a late fee if your contract or terms include one.

Read your numbers

- **Effective rate lower than planned rate** on a project? Hours ran over. Check the "Hours over" column and quote the next similar job higher, or scope it tighter.
- **Outstanding bigger than one month of income?** Ask new clients for a 50% deposit.
- **Weighted pipeline below your monthly goal?** Spend this week on outreach, not polish.

Questions

Does it work in Google Sheets? Yes. File > Import > Upload the .xlsx. Also Excel 2016+ and LibreOffice.

Other currencies? Select the money columns and change the number format.

More rows? Copy the last row and paste below. The Dashboard reads rows 5 to 500.

This is a tracking tool, not accounting, tax or legal advice.